IB English A: Language and Literature · Paper 2

# The Visit

*Friedrich Dürrenmatt, translated by Patrick Bowles · A Paper 2 guide*

Comparative essay preparation
Event bank · Quote bank · Issue arcs by act and across the play
Self-test

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# How to use this guide

Every event, claim and quotation in this guide is tied to the playscript. This guide uses the Grove Press edition of Patrick Bowles's translation. References take the form `Two (40%)`: Act Two, about 40 per cent of the way through the act, rounded to the nearest 5 per cent. This works in any edition of this translation.

Other translations differ: some call Ill "Schill" and the town "Güllen", and the sum varies between translations. Quote only from the translation your class uses.

> **Built for Paper 2.** The issue arcs trace each concern through the three acts. Dürrenmatt's own Postscript and Addenda are printed after the play in this edition and are cited where they help.

# The examination

| | |
|---|---|
| **Course and paper** | IB Diploma English A: Language and Literature, Paper 2: the comparative essay on two literary works studied in the course. Paper 2 is not a set-text exam: the questions are general, they do not name any work, and there are no extracts. |
| **Format** | 1 hour 45 minutes at both SL and HL. Answer one of four general questions, comparing two of the literary works you have studied. 25 marks. |
| **Criteria** | A Knowledge, understanding and interpretation (5). B Analysis and evaluation (10), in two strands: B1 how meaning is shaped by language, technique, style and broader authorial choices (5); B2 the similarities and differences between the two works (5). C Focus and organisation (5). D Language (5). |
| **What this means for revision** | You will not know the question in advance, so you cannot prepare a single essay. You prepare a small number of moments from each work that you know in detail, grouped by issue, and you rehearse how each work handles those issues differently. That is what the issue arcs, the event bank and the quote bank in this guide are for. Comparison must be structural: every paragraph needs both works, and criterion B2 assesses it directly. |

**iSWIM for Paper 2.** Use the five guiding questions on every prompt.

| | |
|---|---|
| **i** | What is the issue of significance? The concern beneath the prompt's topic word. |
| **S** | Why does it matter? The human, social or philosophical stakes. |
| **W** | What does each author want you to understand about it? |
| **I** | How does each author get you to understand it? Structure, form, characterisation, voice, staging. |
| **M** | What does each work position its audience towards, and what does the comparison reveal? The essay-level M comes from the tension between M(A) and M(B). |

Write each paragraph with PEACE ACT: Point, Evidence, Analysis, Comparison, Extension, Audience, Context, Tie-back. Characters do not exist: reach through the characters to the choices the writer makes with them.

*iSWIM tells you how to plan. Thinking with iSWIM tells you how to think. Your text-type guide tells you what to notice and what to call it.*

# Context

Facts about the writer and period are attributed to a named source. Facts about the work come from the work.

### Translation and edition

This guide uses Patrick Bowles's English version, translated from Der Besuch der alten Dame (1956) and published by Grove Press; the copyright page dates the English version to 1962.

Source: Front matter of the Grove Press edition

### Dürrenmatt's Postscript

In the Postscript printed after the play, Dürrenmatt says the Guelleners are not wicked but weak, a community slowly yielding to temptation, and that Claire must be played as human as possible, with sorrow and humour, because nothing would harm this tragic comedy more than heavy seriousness.

Source: Dürrenmatt, Postscript

# At a glance

| Act | Setting | Events | Event titles |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Act One** | Guellen: the station, the Golden Apostle, Konrad's Village Wood | E1–E5 | A bankrupt town waits; Preparing the welcome; Arrival; Konrad's Village Wood; The offer and the trial |
| **Act Two** | Ill's shop, the police station, the Mayor, the Priest, the station | E6–E10 | Wreaths and confidence; Buying on credit; The Policeman and the Mayor; The Priest; The station |
| **Act Three** | Petersens' Barn, Ill's shop, the town meeting, the station | E11–E18 | The Schoolmaster and the Doctor appeal; The press arrives; The Schoolmaster's confession; Ill accepts; The family; Last meeting in the wood; The vote and the death; The cheque and the chorus |

# Event bank

18 numbered events in order. Read one act for close revision, or E1 to E18 straight through as the arc of the whole work.

## Act One

### E1 A bankrupt town waits One (0–5%)

Guellen is ruined: express trains no longer stop One (5%) and the works have closed One (5%). The town pins its hopes on the visit of the millionairess Claire Zachanassian, who grew up there One (10%).

**Why it matters.** The opening places the whole town, not one man, at the centre: poverty is the condition for everything that follows.

### E2 Preparing the welcome One (15%)

The Mayor, Schoolmaster and Ill prepare speeches; Ill, once her lover, is to win her over One (15%).

**Why it matters.** The town's first use of the word justice is as a line for a speech.

### E3 Arrival One (20–35%)

The express, which no longer stops in Guellen, halts for Claire One (20%). She arrives with a butler, two blind men and a coffin One (45%). She reminds Ill of their old names for each other One (35%) and shows the artificial leg from an accident One (35%).

**Why it matters.** Claire is half grotesque and half human; Dürrenmatt's Postscript asks for her to be played as human as possible.

**Dig deeper.** Claire stops the express that no longer stops for the town One (20%). What does Dürrenmatt suggest about who now controls the systems Guellen depends on?

### E4 Konrad's Village Wood One (60–65%)

Townspeople play the trees of the wood where Claire and Ill were lovers One (60%). She tells him she married the millionaire Zachanassian, who found her in a Hamburg brothel One (65%).

**Why it matters.** The love scene is acted out with townspeople as scenery: the past is staged, not remembered.

### E5 The offer and the trial One (85–100%)

At the banquet Claire offers one million, half to the town and half shared among the families One (85%), in return for justice One (90%). Her butler, formerly Lord Chief Justice in Guellen One (90%), recalls the 1910 paternity suit in which Ill bribed two witnesses One (95%). The Mayor refuses in the name of humanity One (100%); she replies that she will wait.

**Why it matters.** Act One ends on a unanimous refusal, which the rest of the play takes apart.

**Dig deeper.** The butler, the blind witnesses and the old verdict turn a banquet into a courtroom. Is Claire asking for justice, or buying the right to define it?

## Act Two

### E6 Wreaths and confidence Two (0–5%)

Wreaths arrive daily for the empty coffin Two (0%), but Ill is sure of the town Two (5%).

**Why it matters.** Ill's confidence is the audience's first measure of how much will change.

### E7 Buying on credit Two (20–30%)

Customers in Ill's shop buy better goods on credit, and Ill notices that they are wearing new yellow shoes Two (30%).

**Why it matters.** Consumption tells the truth before anyone speaks it: the town is already spending the money.

**Dig deeper.** Nobody in the shop mentions Ill's death. Why does Dürrenmatt make shoes, not words, the first evidence of the town's decision?

### E8 The Policeman and the Mayor Two (35–40%)

The Policeman tells Ill the offer cannot be meant seriously Two (40%); he too has new shoes and a gold tooth. The Mayor, with new tie and shoes Two (60%), refuses to act and hands the panther hunt to armed townsmen Two (55%).

**Why it matters.** The officers of law and government are the first to be bought.

### E9 The Priest Two (75–80%)

Ill asks the Priest for help; the Priest speaks of conscience Two (80%), and then, as the new church bell rings, urges him to flee Two (80%).

**Why it matters.** Religion offers counsel and then confesses that it cannot protect him.

### E10 The station Two (85–95%)

Ill tries to leave for Kalberstadt and then Australia Two (90%). The townspeople surround him, insisting they are letting him go Two (95%), and he cannot get on the train Two (95%).

**Why it matters.** Nobody lays a hand on him; the pressure is entirely collective and unspoken.

**Dig deeper.** No one touches Ill. What holds him back, and why is that more frightening than force?

## Act Three

### E11 The Schoolmaster and the Doctor appeal Three (0–10%)

In Petersens' Barn, Claire in a wedding gown receives the Schoolmaster and the Doctor, who ask her to invest in the town instead Three (10%). She tells them she already owns the town's industries and answers with her own history Three (10%).

**Why it matters.** The play states its economics outright: her money has made the town's poverty.

**Dig deeper.** Claire owns the industries whose collapse ruined the town Three (10%). Does that make the town's choice less free, or its guilt less real?

### E12 The press arrives Three (25%)

Reporters arrive to cover the story, and the town presents a romance Three (25%).

**Why it matters.** The media turns the coming killing into a human-interest story.

### E13 The Schoolmaster's confession Three (35–40%)

Ill tells the Schoolmaster that he made Clara what she is Three (35%). The drunken Schoolmaster tells him the truth: the town will kill him, and he himself will take part Three (40%).

**Why it matters.** The humanist of the town admits his own weakness and leaves buying on credit.

**Dig deeper.** The town's humanist knows exactly what will happen and says he will take part Three (40%). Is knowing worse than not knowing?

### E14 Ill accepts Three (50%)

Ill refuses the Mayor's suggestion that he kill himself Three (45%) and says he will accept the town's judgment as justice Three (50%).

**Why it matters.** The one man changed by the play is the victim: he accepts guilt while the town only rehearses it.

**Dig deeper.** Ill accepts the judgment as justice for himself Three (50%). Does his acceptance redeem him, or simply make the town's task easier?

### E15 The family Three (40%)

Ill finds a fur coat in the wardrobe Three (40%); his wife says everyone is in debt Three (40%).

**Why it matters.** His own family has bought into the future without him.

### E16 Last meeting in the wood Three (65%)

In the wood Claire tells Ill she will take his body to a mausoleum in Capri Three (65%).

**Why it matters.** The love story ends as a plan for a tomb.

### E17 The vote and the death Three (85–90%)

At a public meeting before the press, the town accepts the endowment unanimously, not for the money but for justice Three (85%). The vote is staged again for the cameras Three (85%). Ill dies inside a ring of men; the Doctor diagnoses heart attack Three (90%) and the Mayor adds that he died of joy Three (90%).

**Why it matters.** The killing is invisible and its language is entirely official.

**Dig deeper.** The vote is held twice, once for real and once for the cameras Three (85%). Which one is the performance?

### E18 The cheque and the chorus Three (90–100%)

Claire looks at the body and calls him the black panther again Three (90%). She hands over the cheque and leaves with the coffin, and the townspeople, prosperous now, sing a chorus thanking fate for their good fortune Three (100%).

**Why it matters.** The ending parodies Greek tragedy: a chorus that celebrates the crime as a blessing.

**Dig deeper.** The ending borrows the chorus of Greek tragedy Three (95%). What is the effect of a tragic form celebrating good fortune?

# Characters

## Claire Zachanassian

*The richest woman in the world, born Clara Wascher in Guellen* One (10%).

- Returns with a coffin One (45%).
- Offers the million in return for justice One (90%).
- Owns the town's industry Three (10%).

**Arc.** Unchanged from start to finish: she waits, and the town comes to her.

## Alfred III

*Guellen's most popular citizen, a shopkeeper, Claire's former lover.*

- Bribed witnesses in the 1910 paternity case One (95%).
- Notices the shoes and the credit before anyone admits anything Two (30%).
- Accepts judgment Three (50%).

**Arc.** From confidence to fear to acceptance.

## The Mayor, Policeman, Priest and Schoolmaster

*The town's institutions.*

- The Mayor refuses in the name of humanity One (100%) and later suggests suicide Three (45%).
- The Policeman offers the law's protection with a new gold tooth Two (50%).
- The Schoolmaster speaks the truth only when drunk Three (35%).

**Arc.** Each yields in turn, in the order the play arranges.

# Themes

Each theme is traced through the work. Quotation numbers refer to the quote bank.

## Justice and its price

Claire calls her revenge justice and buys it; the town calls the killing justice and is paid for it. The play asks whether justice that can be bought is justice at all.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Act One** | Justice is first a line for a speech One (15%), then a demand backed by money One (90%) and argued by her former judge One (90%).<br>Quotations: Q2, Q4, Q7, Q8, Q9, Q10 |
| **Act Two** | The Policeman insists the law will protect Ill while doubting the offer Two (40%).<br>Quotations: Q14 |
| **Act Three** | Ill accepts the town's judgment as justice for himself Three (50%); the town votes for justice, not money Three (85%).<br>Quotations: Q21, Q27, Q29, Q30, Q31 |

**The whole arc.** The word justice moves from Claire to the town; by the end it covers a murder.

> **Dig deeper**
>
> - Can a wrong committed decades ago still demand consequences today, even if the person who did it has lived an unremarkable life since?
> - What happens when institutions fail to deliver accountability? Claire's case was heard and decided in 1910 by a bribed court One (95%).
> - At what point does the pursuit of justice stop being justice? Compare Claire's demand One (90%) with the town's vote Three (85%).

## Money, poverty and consumption

Poverty makes the bargain possible and credit makes it irreversible. Dürrenmatt shows the town committing itself through shopping before it commits itself by vote.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Act One** | The town is bankrupt One (5%); the offer is precise One (85%).<br>Quotations: Q1, Q6, Q7 |
| **Act Two** | Customers buy on credit and wear new shoes Two (30%).<br>Quotations: Q13, Q14, Q17 |
| **Act Three** | Claire reveals she owns the town's industry Three (10%); Ill's family are in debt Three (40%); the chorus celebrates prosperity Three (100%).<br>Quotations: Q20, Q21, Q24, Q35 |

**The whole arc.** Money moves from offer, to credit, to cash; morality follows the same path.

**Dig deeper**

- Is moral conviction a luxury that needs material security? The town refuses while it is poor and proud One (100%).
- If prosperity has an ugly origin, is the prosperity itself tainted? If we benefit from wrongs we did not commit, are we complicit?

## Collective guilt and complicity

No single person kills Ill. The play makes guilt collective, unspoken and finally official.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Act One** | The town refuses unanimously One (100%).<br>Quotations: Q5, Q10, Q11 |
| **Act Two** | Ill believes the town is with him Two (5%); at the station the crowd hems him in while saying he is free Two (95%).<br>Quotations: Q12, Q13, Q16, Q18 |
| **Act Three** | The Schoolmaster admits the town's corruption Three (35%); the vote is unanimous again, the other way Three (85%); the death is reported as joy Three (90%).<br>Quotations: Q22, Q24, Q25, Q26, Q30, Q32, Q35 |

**The whole arc.** Two unanimous decisions frame the play, and the second cancels the first.

**Dig deeper**

- When a whole community takes part in a harmful act, who is guilty: everyone equally, the person who proposed it, or the person who did not object?
- Can a process be democratic and immoral at the same time? The vote is unanimous both times Three (85%).

## The individual and the community

Ill begins as a popular shopkeeper and ends as the only person in the play who accepts his guilt. Dürrenmatt's Postscript calls the town weak rather than wicked; Ill is the one who grows.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Act One** | Ill is to be the town's go-between with Claire One (15%).<br>Quotations: – |
| **Act Two** | He sees the change before anyone admits it Two (30%) and fails to leave Two (95%).<br>Quotations: Q12, Q15, Q19 |
| **Act Three** | He refuses suicide and accepts judgment Three (50%).<br>Quotations: Q23, Q25, Q27 |

**The whole arc.** The individual gains moral stature exactly as the community loses it.

**Dig deeper**

- Ill accepts guilt for the past Three (35%). Does that make his death just, or does it only show that he is the one person still capable of a moral act?

## Gender, the body and power

Claire's power comes from what was done to her body: the abandoned pregnancy, the brothel, the accident. She now owns bodies in turn.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Act One** | She shows her artificial leg One (35%) and recalls the brothel One (65%).<br>Quotations: Q3, Q6 |
| **Act Two** | Her absence controls the town; her panther roams it Two (55%).<br>Quotations: – |
| **Act Three** | She states her principle Three (10%) and claims Ill's body Three (65%).<br>Quotations: Q21, Q23, Q28 |

**The whole arc.** The woman once bought is now the buyer.

**Dig deeper**

- Claire was judged, shamed and sold as a young woman One (65%). How far does the play ask you to understand her, and how far to fear her?

## Religion and moral language

Church, school and press supply the vocabulary of virtue, and each uses it to excuse the town.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Act One** | Humanity is invoked to refuse the offer One (100%).<br>Quotations: – |
| **Act Two** | The Priest preaches conscience, then tells Ill to flee Two (80%).<br>Quotations: Q15, Q16 |
| **Act Three** | The meeting and the final chorus use solemn language for a killing Three (100%).<br>Quotations: Q29, Q31, Q33 |

**The whole arc.** Moral language survives intact while its meaning is reversed.

**Dig deeper**

- How does the language of community decision change the moral character of an act? Track the words justice, humanity and ideals through Act Three Three (75%).

# Theme and act grid

Reading a row from left to right gives that theme's arc.

| Theme | Act One | Act Two | Act Three |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Justice and its price** | Q2, Q4, Q7, Q8, Q9, Q10 | Q14 | Q21, Q27, Q29, Q30, Q31 |
| **Money, poverty and consumption** | Q1, Q6, Q7 | Q13, Q14, Q17 | Q20, Q21, Q24, Q35 |
| **Collective guilt and complicity** | Q5, Q10, Q11 | Q12, Q13, Q16, Q18 | Q22, Q24, Q25, Q26, Q30, Q32, Q35 |
| **The individual and the community** | | Q12, Q15, Q19 | Q23, Q25, Q27 |
| **Gender, the body and power** | Q3, Q6 | | Q21, Q23, Q28 |
| **Religion and moral language** | | Q15, Q16 | Q29, Q31, Q33 |
| **Death and ritual** | Q3, Q4 | | Q28, Q32, Q34 |

# Dürrenmatt’s methods: the playscript

AO3: how the writer creates meanings and effects through language, structure and form.

### Tragicomedy and the grotesque

Dürrenmatt’s Postscript calls the play a comedy with a tragic end; grotesque details (the artificial leg, the blind eunuchs, the panther) sit beside a killing One (35%).

### Townspeople as scenery

Citizens play the trees of Konrad’s Village Wood One (60%): the community literally forms the setting.

### Repetition and choruses

Phrases are repeated by groups until they lose meaning Two (95%); the ending turns the townspeople into a chorus resembling Greek tragedy Three (95%).

### Props as evidence

New shoes, a gold tooth and a fur coat carry the plot Two (30%) Two (50%) Three (40%).

### The press and the staged vote

The meeting is repeated for the cameras Three (85%), showing public virtue as performance.

# Dig deeper

The surface overview is in the event bank and issue arcs. These sections take the play further: as a parable about post-war Europe, about money and power, about guilt, and about the audience. Every claim about the play is referenced; critical readings are offered for evaluation, and Dürrenmatt's Postscript is quoted where it helps.

## Guellen as a post-war microcosm

**On the surface.** A poor town is offered money to kill a man.

The play, written in 1956, can be read as a parable about Switzerland's post-war conscience: a neutral nation that kept its peace and wealth through compromises it preferred not to examine. Guellen's first refusal is its self-image One (100%); its later prosperity is its reality Three (100%).

The town excuses itself with a single phrase Three (5%). It could be argued that the play makes neutrality and prosperity active choices, and treats "humanity" as the name a community gives to its weakness.

This is an interpretation, not something the play states: Guellen is never placed in a named country.

> **Questions to explore**
>
> - What compromises might a comfortable society have accepted for its comfort?
> - Is a society that refuses to look at the origin of its wealth innocent, or merely ignorant?

## Claire as global capital

**On the surface.** A rich woman takes revenge on a former lover.

Claire owns the town's industries Three (10%) and claims she can afford a new world order Three (10%). She can be read as capital without loyalty: money that creates the poverty it then offers to relieve.

Her body is partly manufactured, an artificial leg One (35%) and an ivory hand One (70%), and she surrounds herself with bought people. The grotesque details make power visible as something inhuman.

> **Questions to explore**
>
> - Is Claire a person or a force?
> - Dürrenmatt's Postscript asks for her to be played as human as possible. What would that change in performance?

## The question of guilt

**On the surface.** Ill wronged Claire, and the town kills him.

Ill's guilt is real: he denied paternity and bribed witnesses One (95%), and he accepts that he made Clara what she is Three (35%). His death, though, serves the town's debts rather than justice, and the town insists otherwise in public Three (85%).

The town's guilt is collective and never spoken. The Schoolmaster names it in private Three (40%); in public the meeting uses the language of ritual cleansing Three (85%) and the Doctor certifies a heart attack Three (90%).

> **Questions to explore**
>
> - Who killed Ill?
> - Does Ill's acceptance make the town less guilty, or more?

## How the play implicates its audience

**On the surface.** The audience watches a town go wrong.

The townspeople are not villains but ordinary people under pressure, and it could be argued that this is what makes the audience uneasy: the question becomes what we would do in their place. The Priest says it outright Two (80%).

The final chorus, modelled on Greek tragedy Three (95%), prays to protect the town's possessions, peace and freedom Three (100%). The language is close to the slogans of a modern prosperous society, and it can be read as aimed at the audience as much as the town.

> **Questions to explore**
>
> - What compromises have I accepted for comfort or security?
> - Is my society's prosperity built on wrongs it does not discuss?

## Dürrenmatt's Postscript: comedy with a tragic end

**On the surface.** The play is dark.

In the Postscript printed after the play, Dürrenmatt insists that the Guelleners are not wicked but weak, a community slowly yielding to temptation, and that the yielding must be visible on stage. He asks for Claire to be played with sorrow and humour rather than as a villain, because heavy seriousness would harm what he calls a comedy with a tragic end.

The grotesque elements, the blind eunuchs One (50%), the panther Two (55%), the coffin carried in with the luggage One (45%), keep the audience laughing at moments when it should be appalled, which is part of how the play works.

> **Questions to explore**
>
> - Why might a writer choose comedy for a story about collective murder?
> - Does laughter make the audience complicit?

Source: Dürrenmatt, Postscript

## Issues of significance

**On the surface.** Use these to open discussion or plan a Paper 2 comparison.

Justice and its shelf life: can an old wrong still demand consequences? Poverty and principle: is moral conviction a luxury of comfort? Democratic process and moral outcomes: can a unanimous, proper vote produce a wrong? Justice versus revenge: what happens when institutions fail? Collective guilt and individual responsibility: who is guilty when everyone acts? The price of prosperity: are we complicit in wrongs we benefit from?

# Quote bank

35 quotations in order of appearance.

## Act One

| No. | Ref. | Quotation and note |
|---|---|---|
| Q1 | One (5%) | "Now not even the commuting trains stop"<br>The town's ruin measured by the trains that pass it by.<br>Money |
| Q2 | One (15%) | "Clara loved justice"<br>Justice enters the play as an anecdote for a welcome speech.<br>Justice and its price |
| Q3 | One (35%) | "I used to call you my black panther"<br>A lover's name that becomes the name of the hunted animal.<br>Gender · Death and ritual |
| Q4 | One (45%) | "Yes, I brought a coffin with me. I may need it."<br>The plot announced as luggage.<br>Death and ritual · Justice and its price |
| Q5 | One (50%) | "We can smell it"<br>The blind eunuchs sense what they cannot see; they could be read as bystanders who see no evil.<br>Collective guilt and complicity |
| Q6 | One (65%) | "He found me in a brothel"<br>Her fortune began in the sale of her body; the play does not let the audience forget it.<br>Gender · Money |
| Q7 | One (85%) | "I'm ready to give Guellen one million"<br>The offer, stated as a contribution to the town's joy.<br>Money · Justice and its price |
| Q8 | One (90%) | "she insists that justice be done"<br>The butler's legal phrasing turns revenge into a claim of justice.<br>Justice and its price |
| Q9 | One (90%) | "I was Lord Chief Justice in Guellen"<br>The judge who once heard her case now works for her.<br>Justice and its price |
| Q10 | One (100%) | "I reject it in the name of humanity"<br>The town's refusal, applauded; the play will test every word of it.<br>Collective guilt and complicity · Justice and its price |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Q11 | One (100%) | “We would rather have poverty than blood on our hands”<br>A moral position the town will abandon without ever admitting it.<br>Collective guilt and complicity |

## Act Two

| No. | Ref. | Quotation and note |
|---|---|---|
| Q12 | Two (5%) | “The town’s on my side”<br>Ill’s confidence at the start of Act Two.<br>Collective guilt and complicity · The individual and the community |
| Q13 | Two (30%) | “New yellow shoes”<br>The first visible sign that the town has started spending.<br>Money · Collective guilt and complicity |
| Q14 | Two (40%) | “one million is an exorbitant price”<br>The Policeman argues the offer cannot be serious, while already profiting from it.<br>Money · Justice and its price |
| Q15 | Two (80%) | “The cause of our fear and our sin lies in our own hearts”<br>The Priest turns Ill’s fear back on Ill.<br>Religion and moral language · The individual and the community |
| Q16 | Two (80%) | “Flee! We are all weak”<br>The Priest admits the community’s weakness, including his own.<br>Religion and moral language · Collective guilt and complicity |
| Q17 | Two (90%) | “new trousers”<br>Another purchase noticed by Ill on the way to the station.<br>Money |
| Q18 | Two (95%) | “We’re letting you pass”<br>The crowd surrounds him while saying he is free to go.<br>Collective guilt and complicity |
| Q19 | Two (95%) | “Someone’ll stop me”<br>Ill stops himself: the town never needs to.<br>The individual and the community |

## Act Three

| No. | Ref. | Quotation and note |
|---|---|---|
| Q20 | Three (10%) | “I can’t buy Sunshine Square, because I own it already”<br>The town’s poverty is revealed as her doing.<br>Money |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Q21** | Three (10%) | "The world turned me into a whore. I shall turn the world into a brothel."<br>Her logic in two sentences: what was done to her will be done to everyone.<br>Gender · Money · Justice and its price |
| **Q22** | Three (35%) | "That infamous million is burning up our hearts"<br>The Schoolmaster names the town's corruption, drunk.<br>Collective guilt and complicity |
| **Q23** | Three (35%) | "I made Clara what she is, and I made myself what I am"<br>Ill accepts responsibility for the past, not for the town's choice.<br>The individual and the community · Gender |
| **Q24** | Three (40%) | "Everyone's making debts, Freddy"<br>Ill's wife treats the town's spending as normal.<br>Money · Collective guilt and complicity |
| **Q25** | Three (40%) | "I can feel myself slowly becoming a murderer"<br>The Schoolmaster watches his own corruption happen.<br>Collective guilt and complicity · The individual and the community |
| **Q26** | Three (40%) | "I too am scared"<br>The humanist's fear sits beside Ill's.<br>Collective guilt and complicity |
| **Q27** | Three (50%) | "For me, it will be justice"<br>Ill accepts the judgment; the line separates his justice from theirs.<br>Justice and its price · The individual and the community |
| **Q28** | Three (65%) | "I shall take you in your coffin to Capri"<br>Love ends as possession of a body.<br>Death and ritual · Gender |
| **Q29** | Three (75%) | "We must take our ideals seriously"<br>The Schoolmaster's public speech, which turns ideals into a reason to kill.<br>Religion and moral language · Justice and its price |
| **Q30** | Three (85%) | "Not for the sake of the money"<br>The public vote insists on its own innocence.<br>Collective guilt and complicity · Justice and its price |
| **Q31** | Three (85%) | "root out the wrongdoer"<br>The meeting's ritual language of purification.<br>Justice and its price · Religion and moral language |
| **Q32** | Three (90%) | "MAYOR. Died of joy"<br>The Mayor's euphemism for a killing.<br>Death and ritual · Collective guilt and complicity |

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| **Q33** | Three (90%) | “God have mercy”<br>The Priest’s prayer at the moment of the killing.<br>Religion and moral language |
| **Q34** | Three (95%) | “Take me to my room”<br>Claire’s return to routine after the death.<br>Death and ritual |
| **Q35** | Three (100%) | “Let us go and enjoy our good fortune”<br>The chorus thanks fate for the money.<br>Money · Collective guilt and complicity |

# Self-test

7 quick questions; answers with references follow.

1. **How much does Claire offer?**
   Her factories / One billion to the Mayor / One million: half for the town, half shared among the families / Ten thousand to Ill
2. **Who is Claire's butler?**
   Her first husband / Ill's son / The Policeman / The former Lord Chief Justice of Guellen
3. **What does Ill notice first in his shop?**
   A fur coat / A gold tooth / A new church bell / New yellow shoes
4. **What animal escapes?**
   A bear / A dog / A horse / Claire's black panther
5. **Where does Ill try to go?**
   Canada / Capri / Hamburg / Kalberstadt, then Australia
6. **What does the Doctor give as the cause of death?**
   Accident / Heart attack / Old age / Suicide
7. **Where will Claire take Ill's body?**
   A mausoleum in Capri / Guellen cemetery / Hamburg / The Golden Apostle

## Answers

1. One million: half for the town, half shared among the families One (85%)
2. The former Lord Chief Justice of Guellen One (90%)
3. New yellow shoes Two (30%)
4. Claire's black panther Two (55%)
5. Kalberstadt, then Australia Two (90%)
6. Heart attack Three (90%)
7. A mausoleum in Capri Three (65%)

# Sources


- Friedrich Dürrenmatt, *The Visit*, translated by Patrick Bowles (Grove Press; translation 1962).
- Dürrenmatt's Postscript and Addenda, printed in the same edition.
- The iSWIM Primer on issues of significance and The Visit revision notes.
- The iSWIM framework for Paper 2.